4.1 Finding the Perfect look for an object

Automatic Mapping

This kind of mapping works well with any kind of objects. Surfaces, Cylinders, Spheres. When you click on this option where the amount of projections you need to put on the object, Maya automatically puts that number of projection around it and places it on a flat surface. Remember this can be the best or could be the worst for certain objects. If certain parts are away from the projection it will give you absurd shapes, which you need to stitch together.

Spherical Mapping

This is used when there is a spherical shape on an object or when there are spheres included in the scene. It becomes easier if you use this mapping where you can see a curvature in an object.

Cylindrical Mapping

Comes in handy when you need to put textures on something that looks cylindrical, like a pipe or poles or anything that is elongated.

Planer Mapping

It's used mainly when there is a flat surface. This works perfectly well on a surface like that.

Identify the shape of the object that you will be UV mapping. Rotate it in 360 degrees and see which of the above mapping processes fits in appropriately.

One can access the UV texture editor as we call it from `Windows > UV Texture Editor` where you can modify your map so that your texture will look much more accurate.

Before you can start your UV map, change your interface to something that suits this technique. In your Screen Setup toolbox, click on the fifth icon that says Hypershade / Perspective. Hover your mouse over it, to see the name and then click it. You will see the layout changing, on your left hand side is the Hypershade where all the colours, materials and textures go and on your right is the perspective view. Click on the Panels dropdown in the Hypershade window and select `Panels > Panel > UV Texture Editor`. This will bring the UV Texture Editor in front. If you press `[F]` in the window you'll fit the whole view inside.